

Lucas Achaval

Buenos Aires, Argentina (UTC-3) · Remote

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Hands-on tech lead at Shield, a fintech providing US banking and stablecoin payments for global trade. Background in software architecture, production blockchain systems, and practical product development.

Experience

Shield — Tech Lead

Jun 2024 – Present

Full-time · Remote · US bank accounts, stablecoin payments, and business credit cards for businesses trading across borders. Investors include Giant Ventures, a16z crypto CSX, and Factor Capital.

- Shield's payments platform has processed \$600M+ for businesses in 120+ countries since 2024.
- Lead the technical side of the company: architecture and engineering decisions, and how the team works.
- Worked on the stablecoin payments product in its first six months, as transaction volume grew from zero to \$10M.
- Stay directly involved in implementation, building a significant portion of the product through agentic coding.
- Work closely with compliance to embed onboarding, checks, and limits into the product, replacing manual processes.
- Focus on shipping product changes safely and on protecting customer funds.
- Joined in June 2024 as one of the early engineers, when the company had a small team and a single product.

Self-employed — Blockchain Developer

Oct 2022 – May 2024

Freelance · Remote · Argentina

- Built on-chain automation on Ethereum and Layer 2 networks: scripts that swap tokens, bridge assets, and provide liquidity on DeFi protocols through direct smart-contract calls.
- Operated these systems in production, handling transaction signing, nonces, gas, RPC providers, and transaction failures. Developed practical knowledge of EVM behavior through production troubleshooting.
- Built an algorithmic cryptocurrency trading system from scratch.

ScarlessFoil — Digital Designer and Composite Laminator

Jan 2019 – Mar 2020

Part-time · On-site · Buenos Aires Province, Argentina

- Designed carbon-fiber hydrofoils and their molds in Autodesk Fusion 360, machined molds on CNC equipment, and laminated and finished the final products.

Education

Universidad Nacional de San Martín (UNSAM) — Bachelor's degree in Data Science

Aug 2023 – Jul 2027 (expected)

University of Buenos Aires (UBA) — Computer Science studies

Mar 2019 – Jul 2023

Goethe Schule Buenos Aires — Trilingual High School Diploma, Natural Sciences

2006 – 2018

Skills

Leadership and architecture: Technical leadership, software architecture, software design, software infrastructure, project management

Languages and data: TypeScript, Express.js, PostgreSQL, Solidity, Python

Infrastructure: AWS, RPC-provider integration, transaction signing, nonce and gas management, transaction-failure handling

Fintech and blockchain: Payments and stablecoins, Ethereum and EVM, Layer 2, DeFi, smart-contract interaction, swaps, bridging, liquidity provision

Languages

Spanish: Native or bilingual · **English:** Professional working proficiency · **German:** Limited working proficiency

Certifications

B2 First Certificate in English (FCE) — University of Cambridge

Nov 2017

Deutsches Sprachdiplom – Zweite Stufe — Deutsche Auslandsschulen

Nov 2018

Learn Python 3 Course — Codecademy

Apr 2020